

LOKI

God of Mischief with a will to rule Asgard



Loki was a megalomaniac, who aimed to overthrow his father and rule over Asgard.

ASGARD'S MISFIT

Loki never fitted in among the inhabitants of Asgard. He nursed a virulent grudge against his stepbrother THOR, the God of Thunder, who possessed in abundance the heroic qualities prized by the Asgardians that Loki himself lacked. Jealous of the praise Odin showered on Thor, Loki took up the dark arts of sorcery and plotted for a way to become ruler of Asgard. His love of trickery earned him a reputation first as the God of Mischief, and then, as he grew more and more cruel, the God of Evil. After many attempts by Loki to usurp the throne of Asgard, Odin lost patience with him and imprisoned him within a mystical tree. He eventually freed himself and went in search of Thor, who was then living on Earth in the mortal guise of Donald Blake.



By leading armies against Asgard, Loki helped achieve the end-cycle of

After Ragnarok, Loki returned and took the body of the goddess Sif. Soon after, he fooled Thor into killing his grandfather Bor and being banished from the new Asgard. He also joined the Cabal (see ILLUMINATI) formed by Norman Osborn (see GREEN GOBLIN) in the wake of the Secret Invasion (see pp. 326-7). He is currently trying to relocate the Asgardians to Dr. DOOM's Latveria.

DW, MF

Loki was born the son of Laufey, king of the Frost Giants of Jotunheim. Ashamed of Loki's small size, Laufey hid him away, but the child's existence came to light after the Frost Giants were defeated in a battle with the Asgardians. Odin (see GODS OF ASGARD), the ruler of Asgard, discovered Loki in the Frost Giants' fortress. Realizing that Loki was the son of Laufey, a king whom he had slain, Odin took the boy back to Asgard and raised him as his own son.



Loki's vast magical talents allowed him to overpower Earth's most powerful heroes. Only Thor's efforts—and Loki's own insecurities—stopped the Trickster God from achieving his ultimate triumph.

THE END OF ASGARD

Thor and his adopted home, Earth, became the focus of Loki's attentions. He precipitated the formation of the AVENGERS by inciting the Hulk to violence, and transformed Crusher Creel into Thor's foe, the ABSORBING MAN. He allied with the ENCHANTRESS, and turned Earth's major Super Villains into his pawns during the Acts of Vengeance conspiracy.

Loki finally conquered Asgard and remade it in his own image. But Thor succeeded in decapitating Loki, carrying his mystically-preserved head to observe the final act of Ragnarok. When Thor severed the tapestry that wove the reality of his dimension, Asgard and all its inhabitants vanished from existence.

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

- **Avengers #1** Loki hatches a plot to destroy his brother Thor, accidentally inspiring the world's greatest heroes to form the Avengers.
- **Loki #1–4** In this limited series, told from Loki's point of view, the Trickster God temporarily succeeds in winning power over all of Asgard.
- **The Mighty Thor #582–588** As Ragnarok unfolds around them, Loki and Thor face off for their final battle, then tour the end of the world.

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Loki Laufeyson

OCCUPATION

God of Mischief; later God of Evil

BASE

Asgard

HEIGHT

6 ft 4 in

WEIGHT

525 lbs

EYES

Green

HAIR

Black-gray

FIRST APPEARANCE

Journey Into Mystery Vol. 1 #85 (October 1962)

LOKI

POWERS

Enhanced strength, stamina, longevity, and limited invulnerability; uses his vast skills in sorcery to fly, generate force fields, teleport between dimensions, animate objects, and change his own shape.

